SLAM SPORTS AI

SPORTS TECH 01/10

NBA 2026-27

30M

game views driven by Tap to Watch in 2025-26

THE NBA'S AI PUSH TO GET FANS INTO LIVE GAMES

New app features, creators and tracking data, per Sports Business Journal

SWIPE →

THE NEW PRODUCTS

THE TOOLS AIMED AT LIVE VIEWERSHIP

1 TAP TO WATCH

Access points across broadcasters, internet search and social platforms; it expands globally this season.

2 GAME PULSE

A feed combining AI highlights from WSC Sports, statistical insights and an AI-generated summary.

3 ASKNBA

The league's AI chatbot, drawing on multiple LLMs to answer questions about games, history and stats.

4 BLUEPRINT

A hub of AWS-backed stats and insights on the app and league website, plus a team's top sets.

THE PEOPLE

WHO IS BUILDING IT AT THE NBA

BC — **BOB CARNEY**
SVP, Social & Digital Content
NBA

DB — **DAYNA BLECHMAN**
Head of Business Initiatives & Operations
NBA

MC — **MICHAEL CALLAHAN**
Senior Lead Product Manager
NBA

CR — **CHARLIE ROHLF**
VP, Stats Technology Product Development
NBA

SZ — **SARA ZUCKERT**
Head of NBA App
NBA

MO — **MAGGIE O'ROURKE**
New media partnerships lead
NBA

TAP TO WATCH

YEAR ONE OF TAP TO WATCH

30M

game views driven by Tap to Watch in 2025-26

100

Tap to Watch access points across the league ecosystem

90%

favorability rating from NBA app users

OCT 19, 2026

HOW IT GREW

A MONTH IN, THEN A FULL SEASON

4M+

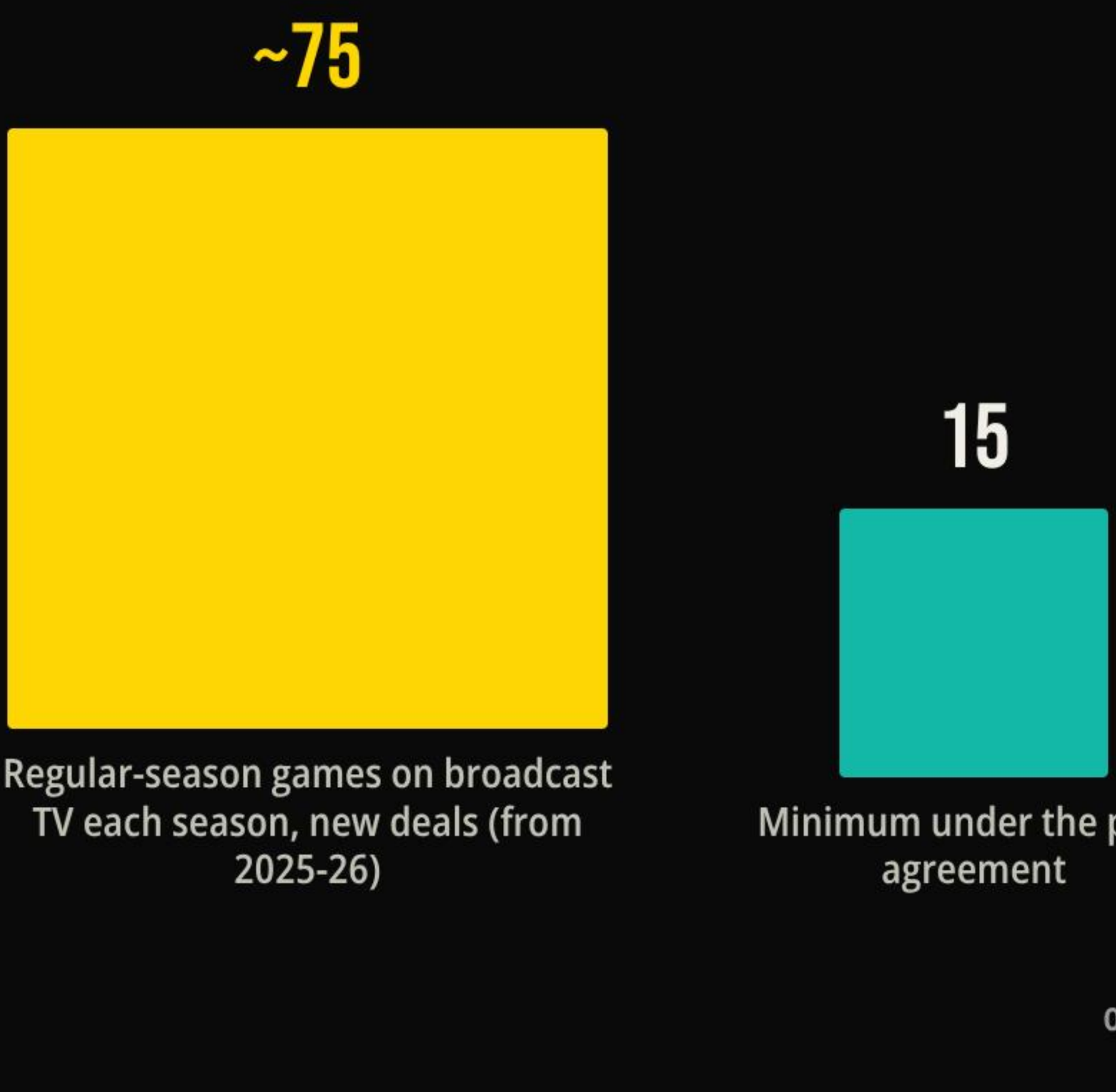
Live game streams referred a month into the season (Nov. 2025)

30M

Game views driven in 2025-26

THE DISCOVERY PROBLEM

MORE NATIONAL GAMES ON BROADCAST TV



Regular-season games on broadcast TV each season, new deals (from 2025-26)

Minimum under the prior agreement

OCT 19, 2026

THE TRACKING LAYER

WHAT THE AWS STATS RUN ON

29

data points per player in the NBA's player tracking data

60

times per second: how often optical tracking data is processed for the Gravity stat

Per the NBA's Oct. 1, 2025 AWS partnership release.

OCT 19, 2026

HOW IT GOT HERE

FROM THE MEDIA DEALS TO GAME PULSE

JUL 24, 2024

NBA signs 11-year media agreements with Disney, NBCUniversal and Amazon

OCT 1, 2025

NBA and AWS announce a multi-year partnership; AWS becomes Official Cloud and Cloud AI Partner

OCT 17, 2025

NBA launches Tap to Watch for the 2025-26 season

11.17.2025

A month in, Tap to Watch has referred fans to more than 4 million live game streams

10.19.2026

NBA details Game Pulse, Blueprint and its creator campaign for 2026-27

“

We have built a technology that identifies all the patterns of movement for every NBA play so that we can quickly match and say, well, how many times did a team run this set or this play or this pattern?

CHARLIE ROHLF

VP, Stats Technology Product Development, NBA

SOURCES

SOURCES

Sports Business Journal: NBA leans on content creators, AI to power new digital products, drive game viewership
sportsbusinessjournal.com

Sports Business Journal: NBA seeing early success with 'Tap to Watch' function driving fans to games
sportsbusinessjournal.com

NBA Communications: NBA and AWS announce new multi-year partnership
pr.nba.com

NBA Communications: NBA signs new 11-year media agreements
pr.nba.com

NBA.com: 'Tap to Watch' to make live NBA games easier to find
nba.com

FOLLOW SLAM SPORTS AI FOR THE SPORTS-TECH STORY OF THE DAY.